

CRANK Stakeholder Onboarding Guide

Your job in KICK is to steer, not to receive a status update.

THE ROLE IN ONE SENTENCE

Stakeholders are external to the build team and attend the Stakeholder KICK only. Mid-cycle requirements you introduce are not disruptions -- they are expected inputs that the Intake Coordinator and CRANK Lead capture and navigate. Your primary job in the room is to make real decisions, not to nod through a status update.

WHAT CRANK ASKS OF YOU THAT SCRUM DID NOT

In a traditional sprint review, your presence was closer to optional and your role was closer to audience. In CRANK, the Stakeholder KICK does not function without you -- or without someone you've delegated real decision authority to. If a KICK produces zero committed decisions because the person in the room can't actually decide, that's a named process failure the CRANK Lead will escalate, not a quiet inconvenience.

If you cannot attend a given Stakeholder KICK, send someone with real decision authority -- not just someone who can take notes and report back.

THE PACE YOUR TEAM RUNS AT

Your team runs at one Pace Dial setting: Full Crank (~2-3 day cycles, a release every cycle), Steady (~1 week), or Governed (~2 weeks, releases batched to approval windows). The Stakeholder KICK is at least weekly at every setting. At Governed it also carries formal sign-off: the release decision for the next approval window is made and recorded before the room closes.

The CRANK Lead is accountable for the setting and changes it with executive sponsor support. Any change starts with a cycle reset, and you will see it logged in the steering document with its reason and a review date.

WHERE YOU SHOW UP IN THE FLYWHEEL

Phase	Your role
Charge	Informed -- you may originate a signal, but capture and triage happen without you in the room.
Run / Assess	Not involved -- this is internal build work.
Navigate	Consulted -- the CRANK Lead may check with you on direction that affects your priorities.
Pace setting	Consulted -- a change to the setting affects when you see releases.
Stakeholder KICK	Responsible -- this is your meeting. Steer, review velocity, and make real calls.
Steering document	Informed -- you can see what was decided and why, without owning the upkeep.

WHAT A GOOD STAKEHOLDER KICK LOOKS LIKE FROM YOUR SIDE

- Live demo, only when there is something new to show -- you are not owed a demo every session.
- Steer: you confirm current priorities still hold, or you redirect them, on the spot.
- Velocity: the CRANK Lead shares real numbers -- cycle time, ship rate, blockers -- not a narrative summary designed to reassure you.
- Escalation Path: if you can't personally commit to something in the room, that gets flagged immediately -- not discovered after the meeting ends.
- Q&A + Team Review: misalignment between what you asked for and what the team built gets surfaced here, not left to fester.

INTRODUCING A MID-CYCLE REQUIREMENT

Bring it to the Intake Coordinator, or raise it in the Steer block of Stakeholder KICK. It gets captured raw -- not filtered or reinterpreted -- and routed to the CRANK Lead, who triages it within 30 minutes: actionable now, next cycle, or navigated around the current work. You will get a real answer either way. "Never Say No" does not mean everything gets built immediately -- some requests get a better solution, a few hit a real limitation, but none get silence.

COMMON STAKEHOLDER MISTAKES

- Sending a proxy without real decision authority -- this is the single most common cause of a stalled Stakeholder KICK.
- Treating the Steer block as a status update you passively receive, rather than a moment to actually redirect priorities.
- Routing a new requirement directly to a Developer instead of through the Intake Coordinator -- this creates an unmanaged, unlogged blocker.
- Expecting a live demo every session -- it only happens when there's something new to show.

- Going dark between KICKs -- if you're unreachable for a genuine decision, name a backup before it becomes a problem.
- Asking the team to slow down informally instead of raising it with the CRANK Lead as a setting change -- pace is set deliberately, not by drift.

SUCCESS INDICATORS

- Stakeholder KICK regularly produces at least one committed decision, not just a review.
- You can name the current cycle's priority without checking your email first.
- New requirements you raise get a real triage answer within 30 minutes, not silence.
- You've never been surprised by what the team built, because misalignment got caught in Q&A + Team Review before it shipped.